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Read NYRR's [Accessibility Statement](#), our first-ever public declaration of commitments to inclusive programming and environments.

In recent years, we have [expanded our efforts](#) toward disability inclusion to further comply with city, state, and federal mandates.

NYRR's History of Inclusion and Accessibility

We have a long history of [inclusion of athletes with disabilities](#) (AWDs) and a multiyear partnership with [Achilles International](#), an organization that provides a community of support for AWDs.

In 2022, Marc Guillaume joined NYRR as our first-ever director of disability inclusion and accessibility. He assists with strategic planning for programs, events, services. Facilities, policies, and procedures related to opportunities for people with disabilities.

With Marc's expert guidance, [NYRR instituted several new initiatives](#), including installing assisted listening system (ALS) technology at the NYRR *RUNCENTER* featuring the New Balance Run Hub, implementing a meetings and events checklist for NYRR staff, and leading staff learning opportunities on various types of disabilities, the rights of people with disabilities, the barriers faced, and common misconceptions.

Recent Key Achievements

"Our goal is to provide a comprehensive range of ADA-recognized auxiliary

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Key achievements over the past 18 months include:

Reasonable accommodation language: For over a year, NYRR has included language on race pages to bring awareness that we offer reasonable accommodation to individuals with disabilities: NYRR strives to host inclusive, sustainable, and accessible events that enable all individuals to engage. To request reasonable accommodations or for inquiries about accessibility for attending this event, please email accessibility@nyrr.org.

Assistive Listening System (ALS) and automatic door opening at the NYRR *RUNCENTER*: Last year we installed ALS technology at the *RUNCENTER* designed to allow individuals with hearing loss or hearing disability enhance their ability to hear and understand audio announcements. This year we added automatic door opening devices at the *RUNCENTER*. Embracing the theory of “universal design,” this accommodation also benefits people such as parents with young children that are using strollers during bib pickup or runner education panels.

“It’s the curb-cut effect,” said Guillaume, referring to the phenomenon of disability-friendly features being used and appreciated by a larger group than the people they were designed for.

Braille on race bibs and medals: NYRR pioneered this feature at the 2023 Achilles Hope & Possibility 4M Presented by TD Bank, and it continued at this year’s race. NYRR is the first outdoor running and wellness organization to take this step.

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...member community, including members with experience, will continue to assess, review, and develop best practices to enhance universal design in NYRR programmatic offerings, then to provide those findings and recommendations to NYRR senior leadership for review and consideration. "Their priority is to strategically structure our approach to integrate disability inclusion across organizational operations," said Guillaume.

What's Next?

At the 2024 TCS New York City Marathon start village, expect to see a quiet space for neurodivergent individuals but open to all, with soothing sounds and low light. "This will benefit anyone who needs a soothing atmosphere and reduced anxiety," said Guillaume.

NYRR also plans to continue to work with the volunteer team to address reasonable accommodation requests from volunteers, to work with human resources to create a more accessible application process for prospective applicants, and to explore continuous enhancement of programmatic access throughout NYRR.

Author: Gordon Bakoulis